XINYU WEI

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Applied microeconomist completing a PhD at ECARES, Université libre de Bruxelles (expected summer 2027). Works on family economics, the economics of ageing and social insurance, turning large, complex datasets into reliable evidence for policy decisions with panel econometrics, impact evaluation and machine learning in Stata, R and Python. Previously wrote public macro-financial reports and taught applied econometrics; studied and worked in mainland China, Hong Kong, the United States and Belgium.

EDUCATION

- **PhD in Economics and Management,** ECARES, Université libre de Bruxelles — 2023 – expected 2027
- **Research Master in Economics and Statistics,** ECARES, Université libre de Bruxelles — 2021 – 2023
- **MPhil in Economics,** The Chinese University of Hong Kong — 2019 – 2021
- **MA in Applied Economics,** Georgetown University — 2015 – 2016
- **BSc in Economics,** Xi'an Jiaotong University — 2011 – 2015

RESEARCH

When Care Supply Becomes Care Demand: How Older Couples Adjust to Caregiver Decline (2026)

- Using SHARE, shows that when a caregiving spouse's health declines, outside help to the household rises but much of it goes to the caregiver; the original care recipient becomes twice as likely to report unmet needs.

Hours You Cannot Choose: The Welfare Cost of Hours Constraints (2026)

- Using Dutch and British panels, shows that many workers cannot choose their hours, at a cost of about a seventh of income that standard welfare measures count as zero.

Exposure or Pass-Through? Income Position and Consumption Risk in China (2026)

- Using CFPS, shows that low-income Chinese households face larger income shocks but show no sign of smoothing them less. Presented at Mannheim (2026) and ECARES (2026).

Temporary Unemployment and Household Outcomes in Belgium (with Bart Capéau; work in progress)

- Evaluates whether Belgium's COVID-19 temporary-unemployment scheme protected household income and employment, using Belgian SILC panel data.

A Comment on "Kin Networks and Institutional Development" (with J. Degroot, P. E. Gobbi and A. Ramos), I4R Discussion Paper No. 126, 2024 | *Paper*

Reports on the US Economy and Federal Reserve Policy (in Chinese), Shenzhen Finance Institute, 2017–2019 | *Selected report*

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ECARES, Université libre de Bruxelles – PhD researcher, HAIOPOLICY project team — Sep 2023 – Present

- Built and documented the project's Belgian SILC panel and delivered tables and figures on income distribution and mobility; analysed Household Budget Survey data on household saving, 1999–2022.
- Designed the project's evaluation of COVID-19 temporary-unemployment benefits; prepared the panel data and produced first estimates.

The Chinese University of Hong Kong – Teaching Assistant (part-time) — Aug 2019 – Jul 2021

- Led problem-solving tutorials and graded assignments for undergraduate macroeconomics courses.

Shenzhen Finance Institute, CUHK-Shenzhen – Teaching and Research Assistant — Jul 2017 – Jul 2019

- Led tutorials for eight master's courses in monetary economics, international finance, Chinese financial markets, econometrics, time series, quantitative methods (weekly Stata labs) and machine learning (in R).
- Lead-authored several issues of the institute's regular public report on the US economy and financial markets; analysed Chinese local-government fiscal data; ran replication checks on faculty papers.

Harvard University, China Gazetteer Project – Visiting Research Assistant — Sep 2016 – Jun 2017

- Led a five-person team collecting and harmonising county-level data from Chinese local gazetteers; ran data-quality checks in Python and Stata.

SKILLS AND HONOURS

- **Software:** Stata, R (advanced); Python, MATLAB (intermediate); LaTeX; Excel.
- **Languages:** Mandarin (native), English (fluent).
- **Honours:** Doctoral Scholarship, ECARES (2023–present); Postgraduate Studentship, CUHK (2019–2021); Third Prize (Bronze Medal), Chinese Mathematical Olympiad, National Final (2011); Honourable Mention, ICM (2013); First Prize, China Undergraduate Mathematical Contest in Modeling, Shaanxi Division (2012).